Flourish
LEGAL WELL-BEING

"Fake Healthy" Snacks: Decoding Misleading Marketing

Today's snack aisles are full of products touting health benefits, but not all are as wholesome as they claim. Let's cut through the misleading marketing around:

"Healthy" Candy

Brands like SmartSweets may have fewer sugars, but they often contain artificial sweeteners or sugar alcohols which can upset your stomach and impact your gut health.

"Healthy" Crackers and Chips

Just because it's made from veggies or alternative flours doesn't mean it's a healthy choice. Always check the ingredient list.

Juices and Smoothies

Fruit juices, and smoothies that use juice as a base instead of milk or ice, aren't healthy (unfortunately). They strip away the fiber, leaving concentrated sugars.

Sweetened Yogurts

Brands such as Yoplait add sugars without the benefits you'd get from full-fat plain yogurt.

Protein Bars and Meal Bars

Most of these are highly processed and stray far from whole food ingredients.

Dried Fruit

Drying fruits concentrates their natural sugars. You'd be shocked how much sugar and calories are in just a handful of dried fruit.

Understanding Nutrition Labels

The best way to tell healthy snacks from unhealthy is to check the label yourself. Here's how:

- **Ingredients:** The more ingredients you don't recognize or can't picture in your mind, the more processed — and probably unhealthy — the item is.
- **Added Sugars:** Naturally occurring sugars are fine. Added sugars, which are listed separately on nutrition labels, are a different story. Avoid them.
- **Sodium:** Be mindful of sodium content, using the % Daily Value on labels as a general guideline.